

SEX PISTOLS BULLETIN

EMI 2566

ANARCHY IN THE UK!

ROCK GROUP START A

THE Sun

4-LETTER TV STORM

Four-letter Punk Rock group in TV storm

SEX PISTOLS



Viewers in big protest over shock outburst



'Worthless, decidedly inferior, displeasing...'

The Punks—Rotten and proud of it!



NEWS ON CAMERA

Evening Standard

Sex Pistols inquiry over four-letter words

THE FOUL MOUTHED YOB

—by TV's Bill Grundy



Fury at filthy TV chat



DAILY EXPRESS

Daily Mail

Obnoxious, arrogant, outrageous... the new pop kings
WHO ARE THESE PUNKS?



THE RAGGED REBEL

SEX PISTOLS

Daily Mirror

TV's Bill Grundy in rock outrage



THE FILTH AND THE FURY!

When the air turned blue...

A POP group shocked viewers of TV's first night with the British television...

Uproar as viewers jam phones

Evening News



GRUNDY GOADED PUNK BOYS SAY'S RECORD CHIEF

SEX PISTOLS

194

Gangs award stabbing rivals

Sick game behind the escalating knife wars

By Andy Newhall
and Neil Thomas

A vicious cycle of gang wars and knife attacks has been going on in London for years. The game is sick, the game is escalating, the game is killing.



POUNCE FOR CRIME ATTACK



'Drill' rap fuels the

A recent report from the Home Office says that the number of knife attacks in London has risen by 10 per cent in the last year. The report also says that the number of people killed in knife attacks has risen by 10 per cent in the last year.



GOONER CLOUTED IN GANG



Top DJ profits from gangs



Matthew Arnold

(1822-1888)

‘The whole scope of the essay is to recommend culture as the great help out of our present difficulties; culture being a pursuit of our total perfection by means of getting to know, on all the matters which most concern us, the best which has been thought and said in the world, and, through this knowledge, turning a stream of fresh and free thought upon our stock notions and habits, which we now follow staunchly but mechanically, vainly imagining that there is a virtue in following them staunchly which makes up for the mischief of following them mechanically.’

Culture and Anarchy (1869)





The Arnoldian Perspective

- ❖ Political democratisation and popular culture = anarchy
- ❖ Industrial capitalism and utilitarianism = individualism
- ❖ Study of perfection = the pursuit of what is best
- ❖ Sweetness and light = to minister to the diseased spirit of our time
- ❖ Liberal social reform = state intervention = a culture for democracy
- ❖ Becomes institutionalised as English literature in teaching in the 1920s



F.R. Leavis (1895-1978) & Q.D. Leavis (1906-1981)

"In any period it is upon a very small minority that the discerning appreciation of art and literature depends: it is (apart from cases of the simple and familiar) only a few who are capable of unprompted, first-hand judgment ... Upon this minority depends our power of profiting by the finest human experience of the past; they keep alive the subtlest and most perishable parts of tradition. Upon them depend the implicit standards that order the finer living of an age, the sense that this is worth more than that, this rather than that is the direction in which to go, that the centre is here rather than there"

Mass Civilization and Minority Culture (1930)

SCRUTINY

A Quarterly Review

Education and the University :	
Considerations at a Critical Time	F. R. Leavis
New English and American Music	W. H. Mellers
Cormac's Ruined House :	
A Survey of the Modern Irish Novel	D. J. Enright
Chaucer (ii): The Canterbury Tales (i)	John Speirs
Comments and Reviews	
The Liberation of Poetry	F.R.L.
'Little Gidding'	D. W. Harding
Hopkins and Yeats	R. G. Lienhardt
'Education for Democracy'	L. C. Knights
Hardy and Criticism	Q. D. Leavis
Current Pamphleteering	Geoffrey Walton

EDITORIAL ADDRESS :
DOWNING COLLEGE, CAMBRIDGE.

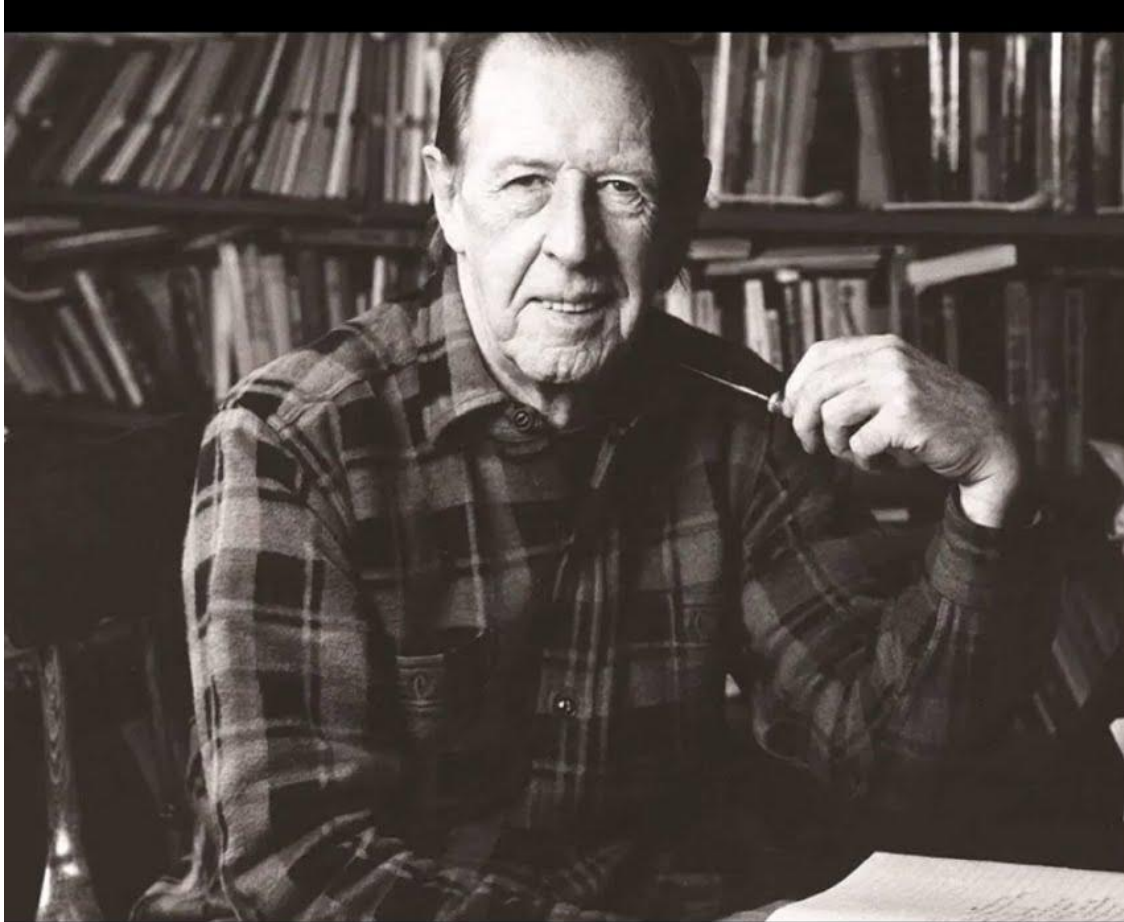
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Street, Cambridge

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Leavisite Manifesto

- Liberal education: *Culture and Environment* (1933). Active concern for declining cultural standards – literary and moral
- Anthropological approach to contemporary culture – culture as a collective way of life
- Common culture = organic community = pre-industrial England = Middle Ages
- Similar to 1930s Marxist criticisms of industrial capitalism but Leavis wasn't interested in socialist utopias
- Cf. Perry Anderson and Francis Mulhern criticisms of Leavisism as a petit bourgeois, moralistic revolt = radical conservatism = national literary canon = English Nationalism
- Free play of critical intelligence and judgement
- Publish good criticism and close reading of texts – literary intelligentsia mobilise around *Scrutiny*

Question: To what extent does the BBC
reflect the “**culture and civilisation
tradition**”



RAYMOND WILLIAMS

CULTURE IS ORDINARY

“ Culture is one of the two or
three most complicated words in
the English language”

-Raymond Williams, *Keywords*



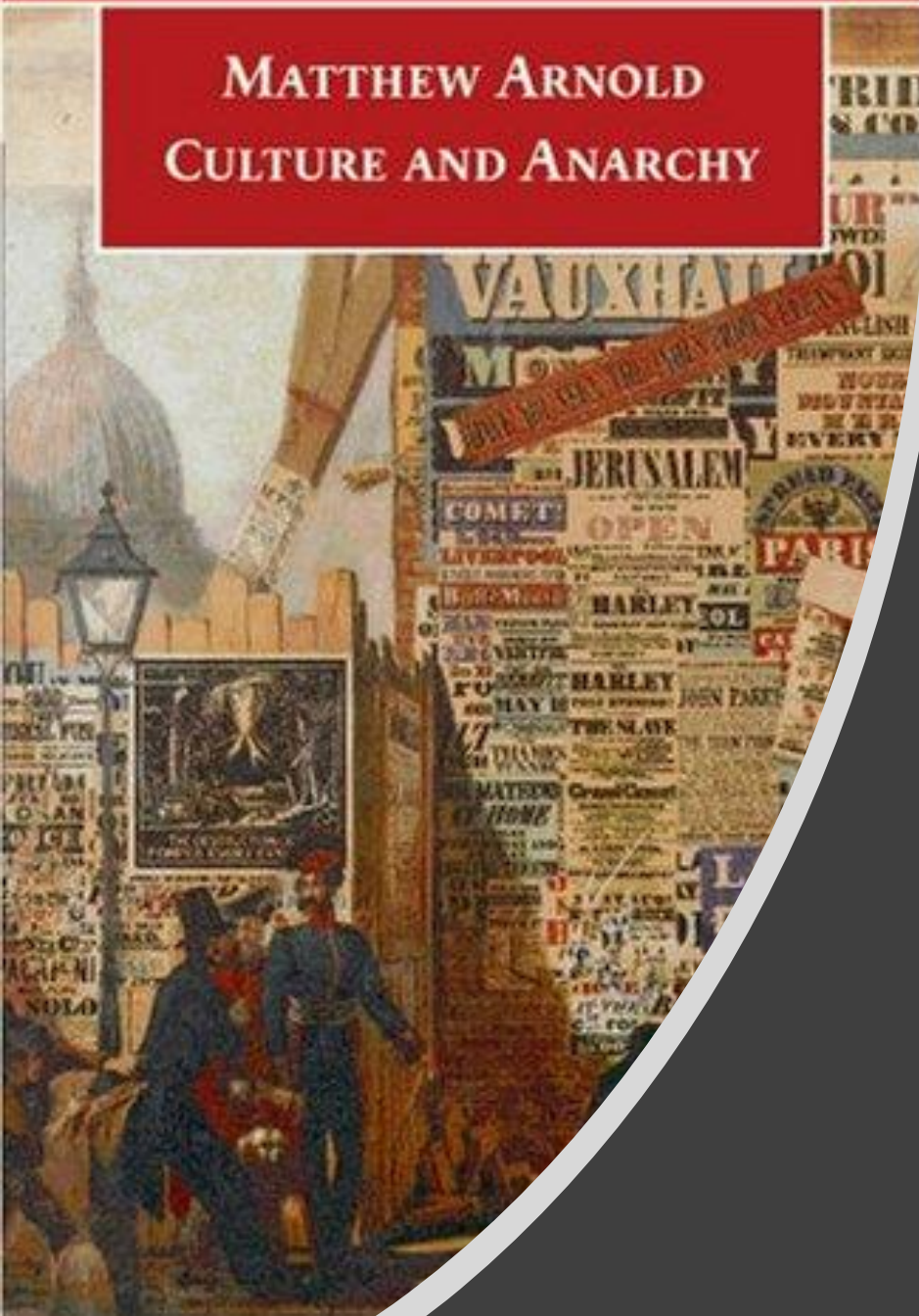
Mass society theory

- Bennett – Culture is not simply imposed from above, nor is it freely chosen from below. It is produced, regulated, circulated, and interpreted within structured relations of power
- LeMahieu - tension between democratic inclusion and elite guidance, illuminating the historical roots of modern debates over public culture and media regulation



Question: Is the notion of 'mass society' still meaningful?

MATTHEW ARNOLD
CULTURE AND ANARCHY

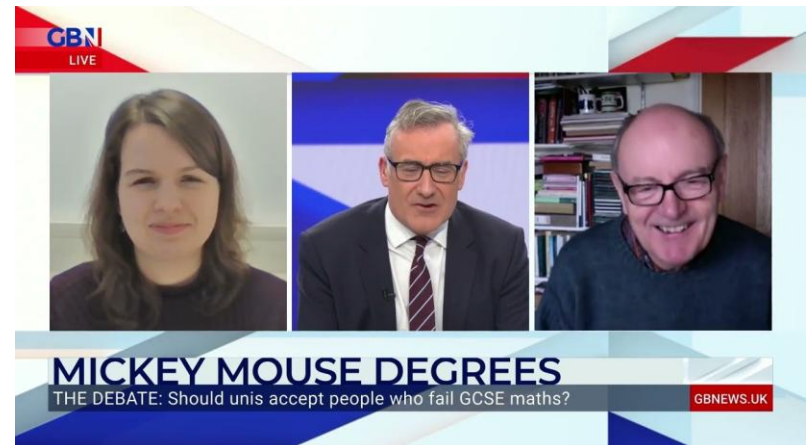


Urban Fear of the Popular

‘... the working class ... raw and half developed ... long lain half hidden amidst its poverty and squalor .. Now issuing from its hiding place to assert an Englishman’s heaven born privilege of doing as he likes, and beginning to perplex us by marching where it likes, meeting where it likes, bawling what it likes, breaking what it likes.’

Mass culture and anxiety

- Carey - the mass culture debate has always been haunted by anxieties about democracy itself. Hostility toward mass culture often coincides with hostility toward mass participation, mass literacy, and the erosion of elite authority.
- Ross- contempt for popular culture frequently masks class anxiety



STUART HALL'S RECEPTION THEORY



preferred
reading



negotiated
reading



oppositional
reading

Question: Using Hall to interrogate media portrayals of class

- For each of the following three images what do you think is **encoded**?
- How might Hall's media reception theory explain different receptions to these images?
- How are the images **polysemic**?
- How was your interpretation of these images reflective of your own social and cultural background?



STUART HALL'S RECEPTION THEORY



preferred
reading



negotiated
reading



oppositional
reading

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WHAT HE REALLY THINKS:

Boris: Working class men are drunk, criminal & feckless

Tory also slammed single mums in magazine rant

By PIPPA CREER Political Editor

BORIS Johnson dismissed workers as "drunk, criminal and feckless" and ranted about "lazy" single mums.

The slur, written when the PM was a journalist, emerged as he targets working-class voters.

Labour's Ian Lavery slammed the Tory's "outrageous" tirade.

FULL STORY: PAGES 6&7

SHOOTY SPECIMEN Johnson yesterday

STUART HALL'S RECEPTION THEORY





STUART HALL'S RECEPTION THEORY



preferred
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oppositional
reading

Questions on essential reading (Strinati, 1-44)

- Evaluate the statement 'mass culture is a threat'
- What has been the influence of the US on mass culture theory?
- To what extent does the concept of 'ironic distance' enable us to understand the reception of contemporary cultural products?